

NARRATIVE INTELLIGENCE

Volume IV of The Anteriority Corpus

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Table of Contents

Introduction

1. The First Reading Machine
2. Orientation Systems
3. The Economy of Legibility
4. Gravity
5. Levity
6. The Detector
7. The Third Term
8. Architecture Is Prior to Governance
9. Narrative Intelligence
10. The Open Question

Introduction

This book argues that institutions, security systems, and markets share a common operation: the transformation of open possibility into administrable categories. Beginning with queer phenomenology and ending with security architecture, the volume develops a theory of legibility and asks how systems learn to read.

Chapter 1 — The First Reading Machine

Recognition requires legibility. Institutions do not merely observe reality; they create the categories through which reality becomes governable.

Author's Note: This chapter belongs to a larger publication project and serves as part of the developing Anteriority Corpus.

Chapter 2 — Orientation Systems

Security boundaries organize possibility before they classify behavior. Systems inherit lines that shape movement long before decisions occur.

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Chapter 3 — The Economy of Legibility

Recognition is never free. Institutions exchange recognition for readability and transform complexity into administration.

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Chapter 4 — Gravity

Gravity names the operation through which possibility collapses into categories, labels, and administrable forms.

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Chapter 5 — Levity

Every sorting machine leaves a remainder. Levity names the structured excess that exceeds available categories.

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Chapter 6 — The Detector

Detectors inherit categories and participate in producing the populations they appear merely to observe.

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Chapter 7 — The Third Term

Reading requires a frame. The interpreter constitutes the relationship between reader and text.

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Chapter 8 — Architecture Is Prior to Governance

Governance manages possibilities; architecture creates them. The deepest interventions occur at the level of the frame.

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Chapter 9 — Narrative Intelligence

Narrative Intelligence studies how categories emerge, stabilize, and organize reality across institutions, markets, and security systems.

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Chapter 10 — The Open Question

Is the surplus real, or merely not-yet-incorporated? The framework leaves this question deliberately unresolved.

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About the Author

Ryann Murphy is a playwright, researcher, and systems theorist whose work explores the intersection of queer phenomenology, institutional legibility, AI security, and governance.